# INHERITED CHARACTERISTICS

**Many of our <u>physical</u> characteristics are inherited from our parents:**

- eye colour
- hair colour and type
- skin colour
- ear lobes
- tongue rolling

} Inherited characteristics

**There are some <u>non-physical</u> characteristics which are not directly inherited:**

- sense of humour
- character
- morals
- persistence

} Learned characteristics – these are characteristics about yourself which you can alter

**Learned characteristics are all heavily influenced by your interactions with your environment.**

**There are some characteristics which seem to a combination of inherited and learned – such as personality and intelligence,**

**<u>Genetics</u> is the study of inherited characteristics – so genetic studies look at patterns of inheritance in physical characteristics of organisms.**

**Inherited characteristics are generally split into two categories – discreet vs continuous variation.**

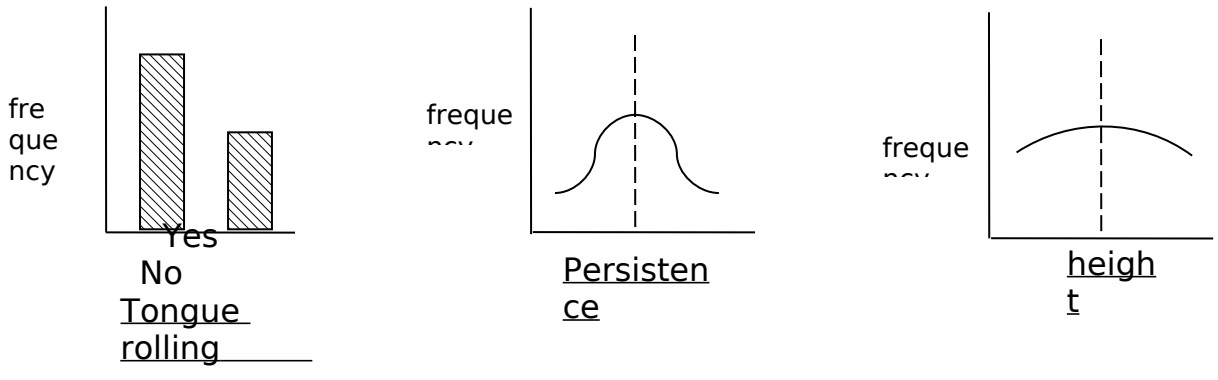
**Inherited characteristics which display a <u>discreet</u> pattern of variation are the simplest form of inheritance – these characteristics have a yes or no appearance.**

Yes – I can roll my tongue.
No – I can't roll my tongue.

**Inherited characteristics which display a <u>continuous</u> variation pattern have to be measured (not counted), and display a range of appearances.**

e.g. eye colour
height

**Patterns of inheritance can be identified by frequency histograms:**

**DISCREET** **CONTINUOUS**

**LEARNED**